

Project Description (2022 HRAF Summer Institute)

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1 Research Question

How do people in pre-industrial societies learn to make tools?

1.1 Sub-questions

1. Do hunter-gatherers have a unique learning pattern compared with groups practicing other types of subsistence strategies?
2. Do learning strategies change across different developmental periods? (More specific hypothesis: will the frequency of social learning decrease through time?)
3. What are some major transmission biases involved? (kin-based? context(success)-based?)

2 Motivation/Significance

1. At the most basic level, this study provides the most in-depth descriptive investigation on this topic so far.

2. It can help improving the external validity of archaeological experimental design.
3. It can serve as a middle-range framework to better understand the formation of archaeological records.

3 Data sources and searching strategies

0. Scope of study: Global sample
1. EHRAF World Cultures: subject “transmission of skills” + key word “tools” (thank you to Carol! Also remember to try specific name of tools like spear/knife/etc. Another keywords include make/made/makes/making.)
2. EHRAF World Cultures: key word “practice” + “tool?” (haven’t tried it)
3. Other ethnoarchaeological works I have read before

4 Variables

1. Area: using eHRAF’s classification system
2. Society(culture): using eHRAF’s classification system
3. Code: using eHRAF’s classification system
4. Subsistence type: using eHRAF’s classification system
5. Year of observation: eHRAF?
6. Location of learning: following the author’s description
7. Location of learning (type): indoor, settlement, field
8. Age of learner: precise age if it is explicitly described
9. Age group of learner: Infancy, Early Adulthood, Middle Childhood, Adolescence, Adult
10. Number of learner: precise number or number group?
11. Age of model: precise age if it is explicitly described

- 44 12. Age group of model: Infancy, Early Adulthood, Middle Childhood, Adolescence, Adult (<50),
45 Adult (>50)
- 46 13. Number of model: precise number or number group?
- 47 14. Relationship between model and learner: horizontal/vertical/oblique
- 48 15. Relationship between model and learner (details): mother/father/etc.
- 49 16. Learning processes: following Garfield et al. (2016), imitation/emulation, local enhance-
50 ment, stimulus enhancement, collective learning, collective learning play, collective learn-
51 ing role play, teaching, teaching demonstration, teaching storytelling, individual learning
- 52 17. Perceived difficulty of skill: difficult/moderate/easy
- 53 18. Amount of time spent:
- 54 19. Type of technology: ?
- 55 20. Raw material: stone, clay, plant, bones
- 56 21. Access to raw materials: difficult/moderate/easy
- 57 22. Restriction of status involved: gender? wealth? religious status?
- 58 23. Transmission bias: using Kendal's (2018) framework
- 59 24. Note (habit, context)
- 60 25. Reference

61 **5 Suggestions**

62 From Sean: Each instance should have its own row. Talking to Mike about Nvivo.